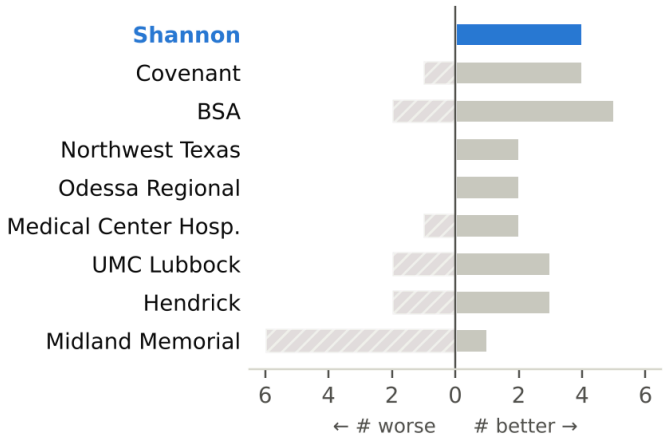
OUTSIDE-IN ANALYSIS · PUBLIC CMS DATA

Shannon Medical Center: Strong Outcomes, One Clear Patient-Experience Gap

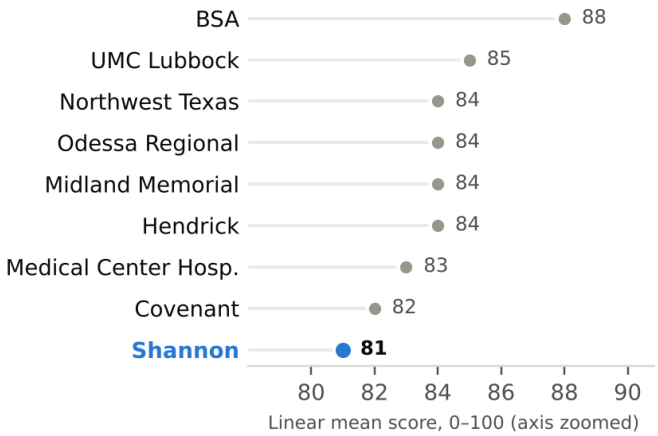
Prepared by Nicholas Campos for the Data Analyst – Quality Resources position (Req. #23351) · October 2026

Compared with eight West Texas regional hospitals, Shannon has the **best clinical-outcome profile in the group**: four CMS outcome measures better than the national rate and none worse. Its clearest opportunity is **patient-rated cleanliness**, where it ranks last of nine and trails Texas and national benchmarks.

Outcome measures vs. national rate



Patient-rated cleanliness (HCAHPS)



What the data shows

1. **Outcomes are a real strength.** Across CMS mortality, safety and readmission measures, Shannon is better than national on **4** and worse on **0**, the best net result among peers. Only three of the nine hospitals have zero measures worse than national.
2. **Patient experience is mid-pack, with real bright spots.** Shannon's HCAHPS summary rating is 3 stars, like most peers. But doctor communication (**92**) is the highest in the group, and quietness is tied for highest.
3. **Cleanliness is the one Shannon-specific gap.** **15%** of surveyed patients said their room was "sometimes" or "never" clean, against **9%** nationally and **8%** in Texas. 62% said "always" clean (national 74%, Texas 76%).
4. **Communication about medicines looks regional, not Shannon-specific.** Shannon has 2 stars here, but 7 of the 9 hospitals (Shannon included) are at 2 stars or below, and its score (75) sits at the peer median. It may be better addressed as a shared, well-studied problem than a local one.

What I'd want to check with internal data

- Cleanliness responses by unit and campus: is the gap concentrated or system-wide?
- Trend since September 2025, when this public data ends.
- Survey comments, and whether scores track with census, length of stay or room turnover times.
- For medication communication: which units score best, and whether teach-back is in use there.

Limits of this view

- Public data lags. HCAHPS covers Oct 2024 – Sep 2025 (483 completed surveys, 20% response rate) and is reported hospital-wide under one CMS ID.
- Linear scores are rounded, so 1–2 point differences may not be meaningful. Star ratings are CMS-adjusted.
- Cleanliness here is patient perception, not audit or infection data.
- The peer group is my selection: general acute-care hospitals with emergency departments in Abilene, Midland, Odessa, Lubbock and Amarillo.

Sources: CMS Care Compare via data.cms.gov: Hospital General Information; HCAHPS Patient Survey (hospital, state and national files). Analysis in SQL (DuckDB) and Python; queries and data at github.com/Aspy1kenobi/shannon-quality-brief.